U.S. Patent No. 6,285,999 B1

Method for node ranking in a linked database

CHARTED AGAINST Google Search ranking by links (PageRank), Google

Patent assigned to Google and Stanford; expired in 2018.

PATENT RECORD — EXHIBIT A-5

ASSIGNEE	Google LLC
PRIORITY	Jan. 10, 1997
ISSUED	Sept. 4, 2001
EXPIRED	Jan. 9, 2018
STATUS	Expired - Lifetime

From patents.google.com, copy of Oct. 29, 2026. 3 of 3 record checks passed.

4	● 4	◐ 0	○ 0	3/4	2	35/39	Nov. 3, 2026
CLAIM ELEMENTS	DOCUMENTED	PARTIAL	NOT FOUND	QUOTES VERBATIM ON PAGE	SOURCES QUOTED	CHECKS PASSED	RESEARCHED AND CHECKED

CLAIM 1 (VERBATIM)	PUBLIC EVIDENCE	BASIS AND CHECKS
1[pre] A computer implemented method of scoring a plurality of linked documents, comprising:	● DOCUMENTED > "We use more than 200 signals, including our patented PageRank™ algorithm, to examine the entire link structure of the web and determine which pages are most important."[1] Google describes PageRank as an algorithm for determining page importance from the web's link structure. Its engineering account also describes computer computation of the PageRank graph across millions of pages.	CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM ● Quote and source ● Quote on page ● Non-patent source ● In research basis ● Dated · no date on the page 2 more supporting sources in Appendix B.
1[a] obtaining a plurality of documents, at least some of the documents being linked documents, at least some of the documents being linking documents, and at least some of the documents being both linked documents and linking documents, each of the linked documents being pointed to by a link in one or more of the linking documents;	● DOCUMENTED > "We start at a set of well-connected initial pages and follow each of their links to new pages. Then we follow the links on those new pages to even more pages and so on, until we have a huge list of links."[2] Google describes discovering pages by following links and then following outgoing links on the newly discovered pages. Those intermediate pages are both linked-to documents and linking documents.	CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM ● Quote and source ● Quote on page · not on the page, copy of 2026-11-03 ● Non-patent source ● In research basis ● Dated Dated July 25, 2008, during the patent term.

1. *Technology Overview*, web.archive.org, https://web.archive.org/web/20100210175913/http:/www.google.com/corporate/tech.html (last visited Nov. 3, 2026).
2. *We knew the web was big...*, googleblog.blogspot.com (July 25, 2008), http://googleblog.blogspot.com/2008/07/we-knew-web-was-big.html (last visited Nov. 3, 2026).

CLAIM 1 (VERBATIM)	PUBLIC EVIDENCE	BASIS AND CHECKS
1[b] assigning a score to each of the linked documents based on scores of the one or more linking documents and	● DOCUMENTED > "PageRank also considers the importance of each page that casts a vote, as votes from some pages are considered to have greater value, thus giving the linked page greater value."[3] Google explains that a linking page's importance affects the value its link contributes to the linked page. This describes assigning linked-page importance based on the importance of linking pages.	CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM ● Quote and source ● Quote on page ● Non-patent source ● In research basis ● Dated · no date on the page
1[c] processing the linked documents according to their scores.	● DOCUMENTED > "Pages that we believe are important pages receive a higher PageRank and are more likely to appear at the top of the search results."[4] Google describes using PageRank to influence the ordering of search results: higher-scored pages are more likely to appear near the top. PageRank is one ranking factor, not the sole determinant of result order.	CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM ● Quote and source ● Quote on page ● Non-patent source ● In research basis ● Dated · no date on the page

3. *Technology Overview*, *supra* note 1.
4. *Id.*

Appendix A · Prior art

Non-patent literature published before the priority date of Jan. 10, 1997. Dates are checked in Python; anything dated on or after it, or undated, is excluded.

REF.	PUBLISHED	REFERENCE	DISCLOSES	PASSAGE	CHECKS
1	1996	*Search and Ranking Algorithms for Locating Resources on the World Wide Web* Budi Yuwono; Dik L. Lee [5]	1[pre], 1[a], 1[b], 1[c]	"then the score of a document is propagated to the documents it references."	● Before priority date ● Non-patent source ● Quote on page ● Labels match claim
2	1987-11	*Searching for Information in a Hypertext Medical Handbook* Mark Edwin Frisse [6]	1[pre], 1[a], 1[c]	"We used these syntactic relationships to propagate query-generated card weights through the hypertext document."	● Before priority date ● Non-patent source ● Quote on page ● Labels match claim
3	1989-08-10	*A Retrieval Model Incorporating Hypertext Links* W. B. Croft; H. Turtle [7]	1[pre], 1[a], 1[c]	"This constraint is applied to each N node in turn (conceptually, at least) and the end result is a ranking of hypertext nodes according to the values of P(Q)."	● Before priority date ● Non-patent source ● Quote on page ● Labels match claim

5. Budi Yuwono; Dik L. Lee, *Search and Ranking Algorithms for Locating Resources on the World Wide Web* (1996), https://www.cse.ust.hk/~dlee/Papers/ir/icde-wise-1996.pdf (last visited Nov. 3, 2026).
6. Mark Edwin Frisse, *Searching for Information in a Hypertext Medical Handbook* (Nov. 1987), https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/317426.317433 (last visited Nov. 3, 2026).
7. W. B. Croft; H. Turtle, *A Retrieval Model Incorporating Hypertext Links* (Aug. 10, 1989), https://web.cs.umass.edu/publication/docs/1989/UM-CS-1989-084.pdf (last visited Nov. 3, 2026).

Appendix B · Research basis

For each element: Parallel's reasoning, its confidence, and every source it cited. The quoted source is marked ▸.

1[pre] DOCUMENTED · CONFIDENCE MEDIUM

The quoted corporate description identifies PageRank as an algorithm analyzing linked pages to determine importance. The engineering blog explicitly describes workstation computation over 26 million pages, while the architecture description states that the links database is used to compute PageRanks for all documents. The computer-implementation support includes a retrospective account of the early system, and the quoted archived overview is undated.

▸ Corporate Information - Technology Overview · web.archive.org/web/20100210175913/http:/www.google.com/corporate/tech.html
Official Google Blog: We knew the web was big... · http://googleblog.blogspot.com/2008/07/we-knew-web-was-big.html
The Anatomy of a Large-Scale Hypertextual Web Search Engine · www.cs.cmu.edu/~christos/courses/826-resources/PAPERS%2BBOOK/google-a…

1[a] DOCUMENTED · CONFIDENCE MEDIUM

The two consecutive sentences describe following links from initial pages to new pages and then following links on those new pages. The intermediate pages therefore have incoming links and outgoing links, supporting the linked-and-linking document roles. The stated publication date falls within the supplied patent term; the mapping from traversal to obtaining documents requires a modest synthesis.

▸ Official Google Blog: We knew the web was big... · http://googleblog.blogspot.com/2008/07/we-knew-web-was-big.html

1[b] DOCUMENTED · CONFIDENCE MEDIUM

The source explicitly states that the importance of a voting page affects the value given to the linked page. This directly supports importance-weighted contributions from linking documents. The archived source does not state a publication or update date.

▸ Corporate Information - Technology Overview · web.archive.org/web/20100210175913/http:/www.google.com/corporate/tech.html

1[c] DOCUMENTED · CONFIDENCE MEDIUM

The source directly connects higher PageRank with a greater likelihood of appearing at the top of search results. Its description of more than 200 signals supports the qualification that PageRank influences ordering without being the sole ranking factor. The archived source is undated.

▸ Corporate Information - Technology Overview · web.archive.org/web/20100210175913/http:/www.google.com/corporate/tech.html

Appendix C · Verification log

Every check run on this exhibit. Green passed, amber needs a person to look, red failed; details for every flag follow the grid.

CLAIM LANGUAGE
Extract API on patents.google.com, copy of Oct. 29, 2026. Split into elements in Python; no model writes claim text.

EVIDENCE
Task API, pro processor, patent databases excluded.
`srun_728f2b03f51547d37de8104ecebb09a0`

PRIOR ART
Task API, pro processor, dates enforced in Python.
`srun_728f2b03f51547d3eb41c524e15b1a6f`

QUOTES, SOURCES AND DATES
Extract API re-reads every cited page from a copy at most a day old; Python compares each quote word for word and checks domains and dates.

PREPARED WITH
parallel

PATENT RECORD	PATENT NUMBER	CLAIM 1 VERBATIM	DATES IN ORDER
US6285999B1	●	●	●

CLAIM ELEMENT	RESEARCHED	QUOTE AND SOURCE	QUOTE ON PAGE	NON-PATENT SOURCE	IN RESEARCH BASIS	DATED
1[pre]	●	●	●	●	●	●
1[a]	●	●	●	●	●	●
1[b]	●	●	●	●	●	●
1[c]	●	●	●	●	●	●

PRIOR ART	BEFORE PRIORITY DATE	NON-PATENT SOURCE	QUOTE ON PAGE	LABELS MATCH CLAIM
Ref. 1	●	●	●	●
Ref. 2	●	●	●	●
Ref. 3	●	●	●	●

FLAGGED FOR REVIEW · 4

- ● 1[pre] · Source dated · no date on the page
- ● 1[a] · Quote found on the page · not on the page, copy of 2026-11-03
- ● 1[b] · Source dated · no date on the page
- ● 1[c] · Source dated · no date on the page